

PHILS HOPEFUL ABOUT BIG CUBAN

Cohen Molds Herrera for Second Base

(Ninth in a series on major league baseball teams training in Florida.)

By TOM BRIERE

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Sports Writer

CLEARWATER, Fla.—The smallest man in the Philadelphia camp has the biggest job.

Andy Cohen, former Minneapolis second baseman and now a Phil coach,

has been delegated by Manager Eddie Sawyer to make a second baseman out of Frank (Pancho) Herrera.

Cohen stands 5-5. Herrera, a gigantic Cuban, goes 6-3 and 225 pounds and could become the largest second baseman in major league history.

The reason for the Herrera experiment is obvious in the International league

batting accomplishments of this strong right-handed hitter at Buffalo in 1959. The erstwhile first baseman hit .329 with 37 homers and 128 runs batted in.

The Phillies already have a major league first baseman in Ed Bouchee and a long-standing problem at second base.

Here's Cohen's wrapup on Herrera: "He's remarkably agile for a big man. He can field the position all right and makes the double-play pivot well. He's got to learn to get a

better jump on the ball, going right and left. He's lost about 20 pounds and is working hard.

"If he makes it at second, it will be because of his own capabilities. But it would be a boost for me, too," added Cohen, the former Miller second baseman in his first year as a major league coach after a managing career in the minors.

Herrera says: "I try."

Other newcomers are expected to break in with the rebuilding Phillies behind the plate in Jim Coker and

perhaps in the outfield with Ken Walters, John Callison and Bobby DelGreco making a strong bid.

Other comments from the Philly camp:

Sawyer, "Pancho Herrera's big bat could help us if he comes through in the experiment at second base. Jim Coker, up from Buffalo, has to improve our catching." (No pennant predictions from the realistic Mr. Sawyer.)

Ken Silvestri, Philadelphia pitcher coach—"One thing we've got is pitching. Not much to go with it, but Robin Roberts, Gene Conley, Jim Owens, Don Cardwell, Dick Farrell, Ruben Gomez, John Buzhardt, Curt Simmons and Taylor Phillips give us plenty of pitching."

Curt Simmons, former boy wonder southpaw trying to recover from a bone chip operation on his elbow at the age of 31—"I don't throw as hard as I did once, but the control is better and I know more about pitching. I feel good this spring and hope I can help again."

Robin Roberts, now 33 and hoping to reverse a 15-17 record of 1959—"I feel as strong as ever on the mound."

Joe Koppe Phil shortstop—"It's better playing short up here than at Wichita in the American Association."

Callison, rookie outfielder who came in a deal from the White Sox—"I haven't hit like I should. I've had a bad leg."

Walters, at Fort Worth last year—"I'd sure like to stay up here." (He threw out two Card runners at second and home from right field and will soon have major league respect of his arm that he attained in the American Association for three years.)

Alvin Dark, veteran third baseman—"I'm still playing, not managing." (He's the darkhorse candidate for Sawyer's job when the inevitable mid-season switch is dictated by the Phils' lowly standing.)



OSCAR ROBERTSON



JERRY WEST

Paced NCAA stars in Olympic trials



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FRANK HERRERA
'I'll try anything'

Three Impress Pollard—West, 'Big O', Bellamy

JIM POLLARD, COACH OF THE MINNEAPOLIS Lakers, is back from the Olympic tryouts with a few opinions.

He was there as a scout, seeking information to help when the National Basketball association draft meeting comes to order.

It is no secret that the Lakers are interested in Jerry West of West Virginia. They can draft him but they cannot negotiate with him until after the Olympics.



CULLUM'S COLUMN
by
DICK CULLUM



ROY SIEVERS
Veeck's manhunt ended



EDDIE SAWYER
He's experimenting

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